## Session-XIV: FWS Field day: April 1st or 2nd week

**Program schedule**

| S.No | Time | Content | Materials | Expected outcomes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 45 min. | Registration and inauguration of exhibition stalls. | | • FWS participants share the learning pf FWS with the visitors. |
| 2 | 30 min. | Exhibition. | | • Farmers from all HUs will visit each stall. |
| 3 | | Purpose of Field day. | | |
| 4 | | Relevance of FWS to groundwater management. | | |
| 5 | | FWS farmer experiences. | | |
| 6 | | VIPs speech. | | |
| 7 | | Issue of FWS graduation certificates. | | |
| 8 | | Vote of thanks. | | |

**Objectives:**

By the end of the day, participants will be able to:

- Discuss the main themes of the exhibition stalls,
- Understand the purpose of Field day,
- Discuss the relevance of FWS to groundwater management,
- Share their FWS experiences, and
- Participate in issue of graduation certificates.

**Process**

**1. Registration and inauguration of exhibition stalls**

Field day should begin with registration of the farmer participants. Separate stalls need to be maintained to register the name of each invitee. After each farmer completes registration, they are requested to go for a gallery walk and interact with the farmers who represent the stalls. Encourage farmers to ask probing questions during the gallery walk. At each stall, farmers who represent that stall should share the theme of the stall, farmer experiences, and learning from FWS sessions.

*Inauguration of stalls*

After the arrival of VIPs, have the exhibition inaugurated by one of the VIPs. It would be nice if GMC/HUN leaders accompany VIPs during gallery walk. This is a great opportunity for farmers and GMC/HUN members to project themselves before district officials and local political leaders.

**2. Exhibition of stalls**

The exhibition stalls are organized in a sequence to help visitors to gain a fair understanding of FWS concepts and core messages. It will be beneficial for the farmers to organize the stalls in the following sequence:

- FWS objectives;

- Basic information about the project area;
- Hydrological Unit and Hydro-Eco System;
- FWS methodology and it's relevance to groundwater management;
- Groundwater concepts like recharge, draft, and groundwater balance;
- Water saving techniques, and soil moisture retention methods;
- Organic practices to control the pest and increase soil fertility;
- Artificial groundwater recharge structures;

### 3. Purpose of Field day

After the gallery walk, NGN President or Secretary has to request all the participants to be seated in the space provided at the venue. Then, invite all the VIPs onto dais and garland them. Next, NGN president or Secretary has to request one of the VIPs to lead the programme. Give the program sheet to all VIPs. The chief guest requests NGN members to start the programme with prayer.

Next, play a small role play to share the purpose of FWS Field day. The script should include the following few things.

- *Introduction to current groundwater scenario*

  Water is the main source for sustenance of life. 30 years back, we had surface water bodies like wells, tanks and canals. Increased population, industrialization, and deforestation have resulted in indiscriminate use. Also, the monsoon has become erratic. As a result, most surface water bodies dried up. Farmers started to drill bore wells for assured water supply for agriculture and drinking water. Presently, the groundwater levels are depleting at a faster rate due to increase in number of bore wells and indiscriminate exploitation of groundwater. In most places, small and marginal farmers are migrating to nearby towns and cities for livelihood opportunities.

- *Why FFS approach to groundwater management?*

  Farmer Field School is an effective tool to sensitize the community of farmers. Also, it provides a platform for collective action to find solutions to problems. A group of farmers will 'observe' a problem, 'analyze' it (why is this occurring?), and 'discuss' with co-farmers and make 'collective decision' to solve or manage the problem.

### 4. Relevance of FWS to groundwater management

Share these lines with participants and explain the relevance of FWS to the groundwater management: The decision making process in FFS approach is useful in observation of water levels and discharge of the bore wells. It helps groundwater users to analyze the reasons for fluctuations in water levels and discharge of the bore well. Then, they share this information with other farmers in the village or HU to understand the groundwater dynamics and estimate water balance. These water balance estimations help farmers to make informed decisions on crop-plans to meet the water demand.

All the above information will be discussed during FWS sessions and prepare the community to adopt water management techniques to make use of available groundwater.

### 5. FWS Farmer experiences

Next, NGN President or Secretary has to invite FWS farmer participants to share their experiences and learning.

It would be useful if farmers share the following:

- FWS methodology and groundwater management;
- Groundwater recharge and influencing factors;
- Groundwater draft, and information required to estimate the draft and balance;
- Water saving techniques, and quantity of water saved;
- Organic practices to control the pest incidence, and reduce investments;
- Collaborator farmers share experiences with long-term experiments; and
- 2007-2008 FWS plan and linkages with line departments.

Ideally, each farmer should restrict their speech to five minutes. After sharing of farmers experiences, request the VIPs to speak for a few minutes.

### 6. VIPs speech

Next, request VIPs to speak to farmers and share their observations and suggestions to farmer participants. Give five minutes to each VIP. If the number of VIPs is more, restrict the number of speakers.

### 7. Issue of FWS graduation certificates

NGN president/secretary has to share the importance of FWS graduation certificate and request chief guest to handover the importance of the FWS graduation certificates and request one of the VIPs to issue FWS graduation certificates to HUN Presidents and Secretaries on behalf of the FWS participants. HUNs will distribute the graduation certificates to facilitators and participants of FWS sessions during the HUN meetings.

### 8. Vote of thanks

A member of the NGN committee should be invited to make a brief vote of thanks to all those who graced the event and those who have helped organize the Field Day. Inform the participants that lunch has been organized for all.